

Colorado Field Ornithologists Sight Record Form
(Please print or type. Attach photographs and additional pages if necessary.)

[A]

Each table cell will automatically enlarge as you type!

CBRC FILE #:

2003-44

RESULTS:

Species: (Common Name) Least Bittern

(Scientific Name) Ixobrychus exilis

Date(s) of occurrence: 27 & 28 June 2003

Number of birds seen: 2

Sex: Male and female (Only the female will be described in this report)

Plumage: Adult

Exact location: Ft Lyon SWA large cattail marsh with road into the middle of it

County: Bent

Nearest town: Ft Lyon

Elevation: 3800 feet

Length of observation: only a couple of minutes each day

Time(s) of observation: 10:30 6-27, 13:00 6-28

Other observers who saw the bird(s) with you: none

Other observers who independently saw the bird(s): many

Light conditions (quality; direction relative to bird(s) and observers position: full sun pretty much overhead

Optical equipment used: 8x42 binoculars

Distance to bird(s) (estimated, unless otherwise noted): 50-150 meters

Was (Were) bird(s) photographed? no

If so, are you submitting photos?

Who took the photograph(s)?

Describe the general and specific habitats in which the bird(s) occurred: The large cattail dominated marsh along the Arkansas River

Describe the bird's (birds') behaviors, particularly behaviors that were used in supporting the identification, e.g., flying, behaviors: This bird would appear as it clambered up cattails then it would fly a short distance and drop into the cattail disappearing.

DESCRIPTION -- This is the most important part of this report. Include in these details the overall size and shape of the bird and give as many plumage details as possible, even including those that you feel might not have relevance to the specific identification. Please fill out this portion even if photos are accompanying your report. My observations were brief but because of my previous experiences with the species I was able to identify it conclusively as a female Least Bittern. Basically it was a buffy-yellow tiny heron. Legs yellowish. The only pattern I noticed on the bird was that it was a little darker dorsally

Describe the bird's (birds') call(s) and/or song(s), if noted: none

SIMILAR SPECIES -- This is another critical part of your report. Please discuss how you eliminated similar species from consideration: There are really no similar species in interior N Am that could be confused with this species.

What is your prior experience with this and similarly appearing species? Vast

List books, guides, recordings, or other sources consulted and how these influenced your identification (during and after observation):

This report was made from (check one) ___ notes made during observation ___ notes made after observation x later from memory.

Date and time of written report: 27 May 2004

Reporting observer: Brian Gibbons

Signature:

Reporting observer's address: 7824 El Pensador drive

City: Dallas

State: TX

Zip: 75248-4312

Send report to:
Colorado Bird Records Committee
Tony Leukering
PO Box 660
Brighton, CO 80601